

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Paige Turner

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Paige Turner

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*
- 2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*
- 3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened an injunction and promised to expose my museum source. The documents concern his collection and his labor empire. I obtained them without his permission, which is generally how reporting works when the subject would prefer an invitation to approve the questions. I was protecting a person, not a flattering profile.

IF MURDERER

He threatened an injunction and my source's identity. I had internal documents, a publication date and somebody inside the museum who could lose their livelihood. Grant enjoyed saying their name quietly enough that nobody else could hear. He expected me to trade the investigation for their safety.



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Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I left the advance program with the press papers, then went into the recording booth to question my source. I did not put their name in my notes. When I came out, Grant was preparing the private toast. I wanted one more document before his speech, and I was prepared to make him dislike the question.

IF MURDERER

I listened to a recorded source interview while moving through the gallery. I had asked Grant for the missing ownership document earlier. Before the toast I checked the file against my notes and put the phone away. He wanted a source's name. I wanted the source to survive publication with a job.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Paige Turner

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Paige Turner

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I called the source Moth in the live booth interview. Its raw record runs from 6:39 to 6:45. I burned the identifying name slip in the metal dish on camera; the documents survive. Source protection can look like evidence destruction. In this instance it was both. The raw interview survives on the source's separate recorder too.

IF MURDERER

Moth was the name I used in the recorded interview. I destroyed the identifying slip and retained the documents. Grant knew there was somebody inside the museum helping me. He wanted their name exchanged for permission to publish. My notes include the questions I intended to ask and none of the permission he intended to require.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Paige Turner

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Paige Turner

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I destroyed the slip identifying my source. The uncut booth recording shows that act and my continued interview through the contamination interval. Moth's copy supplies an independent check. The injunction threat was serious; so was the story. I protected the source and preserved the documents. I did not poison Grant.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I played the earlier interview while I went to the salon. The folder and covered notes helped me pass as somebody pursuing a story. I took the toxin from preparation supplies and wiped his coupe with museum linen. I wanted my source safe and Grant unable to stop publication. I killed the subject of my own investigation.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.